CURTIN EXECUTIVE EDUCATION · ONE-DAY MASTERCLASS

The Human Edge

Using and delivering AI with judgement

Everyone in this room has the same tools.
Your judgement is the edge.

DR MICHAEL BORCK · MICHAEL.BORCK@CURTIN.EDU.AU

COURSE SITE

THE DAY

Four sessions. Four tools. Your own work.

01 · 9:00

Judge

How much should I trust this?

TRUST TOOL

A ten-second habit for every output

02 · 11:00

Brief

How do I ask for what I need?

RTCF

Your own prompt library

03 · 1:15

Check

How do I know it's right?

CHECK LOOP

A verified analysis, and your decision rules

04 · 3:00

Deliver

Will it work every week?

OPPORTUNITY FINDER

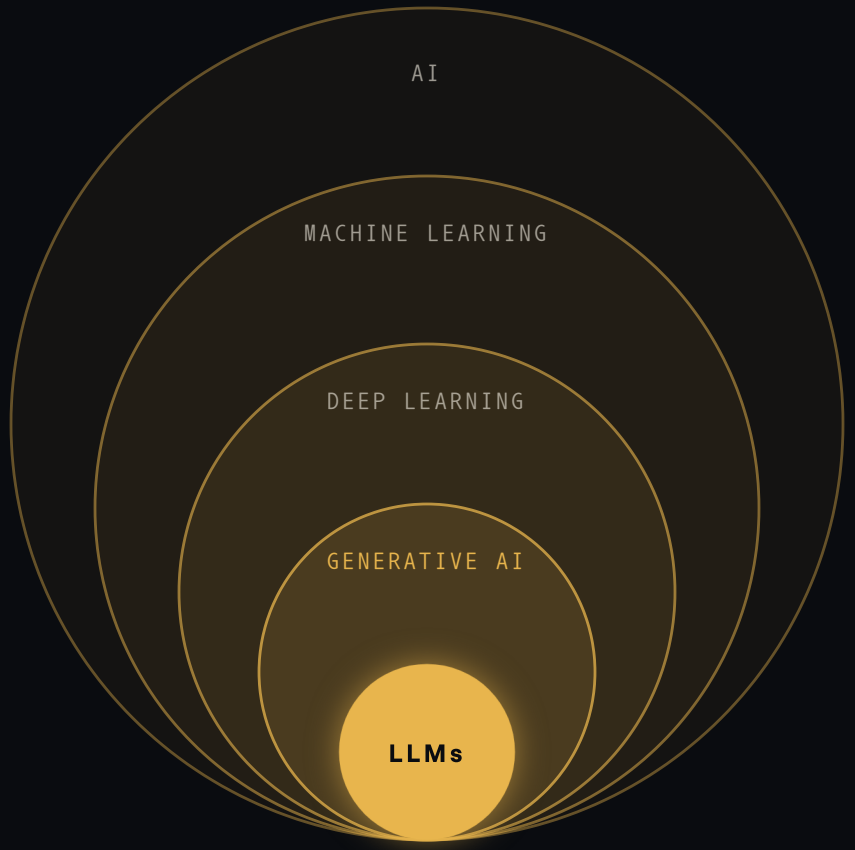
A delivery plan for one workflow, and an action plan

Morning tea 10:30 · Lunch 12:30 · Afternoon tea 2:30 · Close 4:30

The rhythm: a few slides, then you do it.

FIRST, YOUR BEARINGS

AI is a bigger pie. Today is one slice.



ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE
Machines doing tasks that need intelligence.
Rules and search: route planning, a chess engine

MACHINE LEARNING
Learns patterns from data, not hand-written rules.
Fraud scores, demand forecasts, spam filters, recommendations

DEEP LEARNING
Neural networks with many layers.
Face unlock, speech to text, translation, medical imaging

GENERATIVE AI
Produces new text, images, audio and code.
Image generators, voice cloning, coding assistants

LARGE LANGUAGE MODELS · TODAY
Generative AI for language, in plain language.
ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot

LANGUAGE (NLP) AND VISION CUT ACROSS THE RINGS

WHAT IT ACTUALLY DOES

AI gives you the convincing average.

It predicts the most plausible next words. Fluent, well-shaped, usually about right.



YOUR ALARM

AI's mistakes don't look like mistakes.

You spot weak work by its signals. AI's wrong answers don't carry them.

THE SIGNALS YOU RELY ON	A PERSON'S WEAK DRAFT	AI'S WRONG ANSWER
Typos and slips	●	○
Gaps, TODOs, missing pieces	●	○
Hedging: "I think", "probably"	●	○
Uneven formatting, a rushed ending	●	○
YOUR ALARM	RINGS	STAYS QUIET

Both are wrong. Only one of them looks it.

THE SECOND TRAP

Sharp where you know. Trusting where you don't.

IN YOUR OWN FIELD

You catch its errors straight away.

"That's not how our contracts work." "That figure's from last year." You know enough to see it.

OUTSIDE IT

The market, the law, the numbers.

Same tool, same error rate. But it reads as fact, because you can't see the mistakes.

The defence: be most sceptical where you know least.

"Gell-Mann amnesia": Michael Crichton, 2002, after the physicist Murray Gell-Mann

EXERCISE 1 · 25 MIN · SOLO, THEN TABLES

Your pass first. Then AI's.

01 **Sketch your own plan. Five minutes, no AI.**
Bullets in the workbook. Rough is the point.

02 **Give AI the same task, unedited.**
Two tools if you have them.

03 **Compare side by side.**
Where did you beat it? Where did it beat you? What did it get confidently wrong?

THE TASK

```
I manage a team of 8 in a mid-sized company.
One of my team, a strong performer for three
years, has been late and missing deadlines for
the past month. Others are starting to notice.
Write me a plan to address this.
```

OUTPUT Where you beat it, where it beat you, and one thing it got confidently wrong.

TOOL 1 · THE TRUST TOOL

Two questions before you act on it.

QUESTION 1 · PRECISION

How exact must it be?

AVERAGE

The ballpark is fine. A draft, a summary, ideas to react to.

→

PRECISE

One right answer. A figure, a name, a date, a citation, a clause.

QUESTION 2 · CONSEQUENCES

What happens if it's wrong?

SMALL

Cheap to fix, easy to reverse, nobody harmed.

→

LARGE

Money, safety, reputation, someone's job or wellbeing.

Two questions, ten seconds, four corners.

TOOL 1 · THE TRUST TOOL

Four corners. Four levels of checking.



PLACE THESE

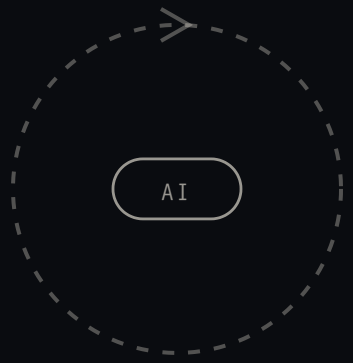
1. A birthday message for a colleague
   TRUST WITH LIGHT REVIEW
2. A summary of a report, for you
   TRUST WITH LIGHT REVIEW
3. A strategy memo for the exec team
   VERIFY THE LOAD-BEARING BITS
4. A statistic quoted in a newsletter
   VERIFY BEFORE YOU SHIP
5. The figures in a board paper
   HUMAN IN THE LOOP

TOOL 1 · THE TRUST TOOL

Check from outside the tool.

Better models move the corners. They never remove the check.

ASKING IT TO CHECK ITSELF

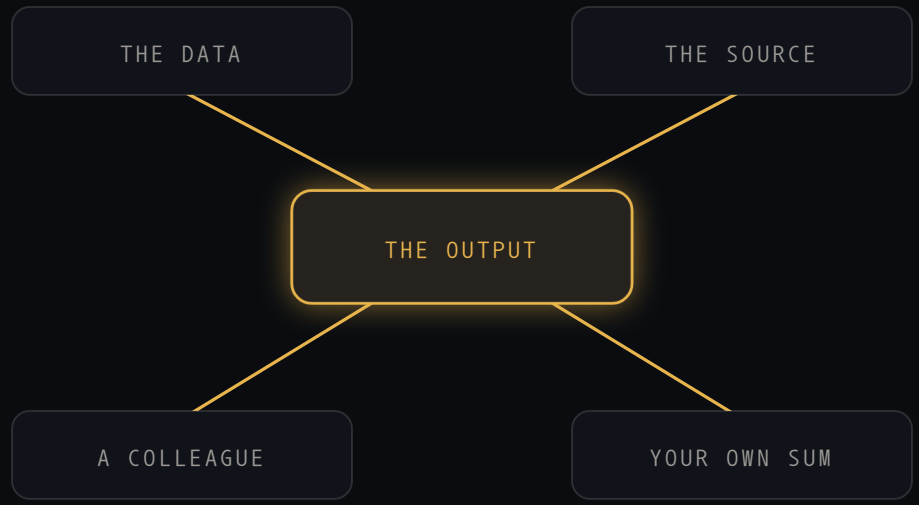


"Are you sure?"

"Yes, I'm confident this is correct."

SAME BLIND SPOTS, TWICE

CHECKING FROM OUTSIDE



Recount it. Open the document. Ask someone who knows.

EXERCISE 2 · 22 MIN · ROOM, THEN SOLO

Place it. Then argue about it.

01 Blind vote. I read a scenario. Decide in silence, then vote on "three".

Five scenarios. A split room is the point.

02 Play the game. Choose your domain and place all ten cards.

Read the explanation on any card you miss.

03 Place three tasks from your own week in your workbook.

Swap with a neighbour. Where do you disagree, and why?

THE GAME

trusttool.borck.education

Free, no login, works on a phone.

HOW TO VOTE

ClassPulse on your phone or laptop: scan the code on screen. No signal? **Fingers**, 1 to 4:

- **1 · A** Light review
- **2 · B** Load-bearing bits
- **3 · C** Before you ship
- **4 · D** Human in the loop

OUTPUT Three of your own tasks, placed, with the check each one needs.

BEFORE THE BREAK

Three rules before you paste.

01

Classify it, then pick the tool.

Public, internal, confidential or regulated? Anything internal or above goes only into tools your organisation has approved for it.

02

Leave out what identifies people.

Names, health details, client data, anything under NDA. Describe the shape of the data instead of pasting it.

03

Know what it remembers.

Saved memories, inferred memories and chat history are kept separately. Deleting a chat may not delete what it learned. Use a temporary chat for anything sensitive.

Check yours now, two minutes. Open your tool's data settings. Is it training on what you type? Is memory on?

And: your name goes on the output, not the tool's.

SESSION 2 · BRIEF

Brief it like a capable new colleague.

No magic words. Smart, fast, and brand new to your job.

WHAT YOU KNOW
Who it's for, and what they care about
What happened last time
The politics
What good looks like here

THE BRIEF →

WHAT IT KNOWS
How emails, reports and plans usually go
A great deal of public information
Nothing about your client, your team or your standards

TOOL 2 · RTCF

Four parts of a good brief.

R

Role

Who should it write as?

```
A senior HR adviser
in a mid-sized
Australian firm
```

T

Task

What exactly, and how much?

```
Draft a reply. Under
200 words.
```

C

Context

What does it need to know?

```
18-month client.
Their board shifted
priorities. I want a
meeting, not a
rewrite.
```

DOES MOST OF THE WORK

F

Format

What should it look like?

```
Email. Acknowledge,
explain, propose,
close.
```

Not every prompt needs all four. Anything that matters does.

TOOL 2 · RTCF

One minute of briefing. Thirty minutes saved.

BEFORE

```
Write an email about the project delay.
```

Generic, polite, and unusable without a rewrite.

AFTER

```
ROLE Senior project manager. Plain-spoken and warm.
TASK Write to the client about a two-week delivery delay.
CONTEXT A vendor's API integration ran late. The client values
transparency and the relationship is good. New date: 15 March.
FORMAT Under 200 words. Acknowledge, explain, new date, recommit.
```

Close to something you'd send.

EXERCISE 3 · 25 MIN · SOLO

Brief it. Twice.

01 Pick a real task from your week.

Or a scenario card from the course site if your work is confidential.

02 Round 1: write it the way you normally would. Run it. Score it 1 to 5.

Score on one question: how close is this to usable?

03 Round 2: rewrite it with RTCF. Run it in a fresh chat. Score again.

04 Note which part moved the score most.

RTCF TEMPLATE

```
ROLE You are a ...
TASK Write / summarise / compare ... (how much?)
CONTEXT The audience is ... The situation is ...
Good looks like ...
FORMAT Length ... Structure ... Tone ...
```

Prompt builder on the course site.

OUTPUT A before and after for one real task, with scores.

TOOL 2 · RTCF UPGRADES

Weak models can't infer. So leave nothing to infer.

Four upgrades. They help smaller, older and free-tier models most, and the best models still do better with them.

+ EXAMPLE

Show it one you liked.

```
Match the length and tone of this example: [paste]
```

+ DONE

Say what done looks like.

```
Done means under 200 words, figures only from my notes,
and anything you're unsure of marked [CHECK].
```

+ QUESTIONS

Let it ask first.

```
Before you start, ask me up to five questions.
```

+ STEPS

Split the job.

```
Give me an outline only. We'll draft one section at a
time.
```

AGREEABLE IS NOT HONEST

Push back. Three ways.

Models are tuned to please. Disagree with no evidence and many will fold.

01 · SET A GUARDRAIL

Keep it honest.

```
Only change your assessment if I
give you a new fact. Name the
fact that changed it.
```

02 · DEVIL'S ADVOCATE

Make it attack.

```
Don't flatter me. Give me three
reasons this fails, and name the
assumption it all rests on.
```

03 · BOARD OF DIRECTORS

Hear a room, not a voice.

```
Respond as a board: a CFO, a
sceptical customer and a
frontline manager. One paragraph
each, then where they disagree.
```

You decide what survives. And for an independent read, start a fresh chat: long chats drift towards your view.

EXERCISE 4 · 25 MIN · SOLO

Upgrade it. Then save it.

01 **Take your best Round 2 prompt. Add one upgrade and run it.**
Example, done, questions or steps.

02 **Push back with no new evidence. Does it fold or hold?**
Then try the guardrail, devil's advocate or the board.

03 **Save three prompts to your library.**
Name, when to use it, the prompt with [blanks], and the check it needs.

04 **Stretch: the voice pass.**
Have it rewrite its output in your voice. Steps in the workbook.

A LIBRARY ENTRY

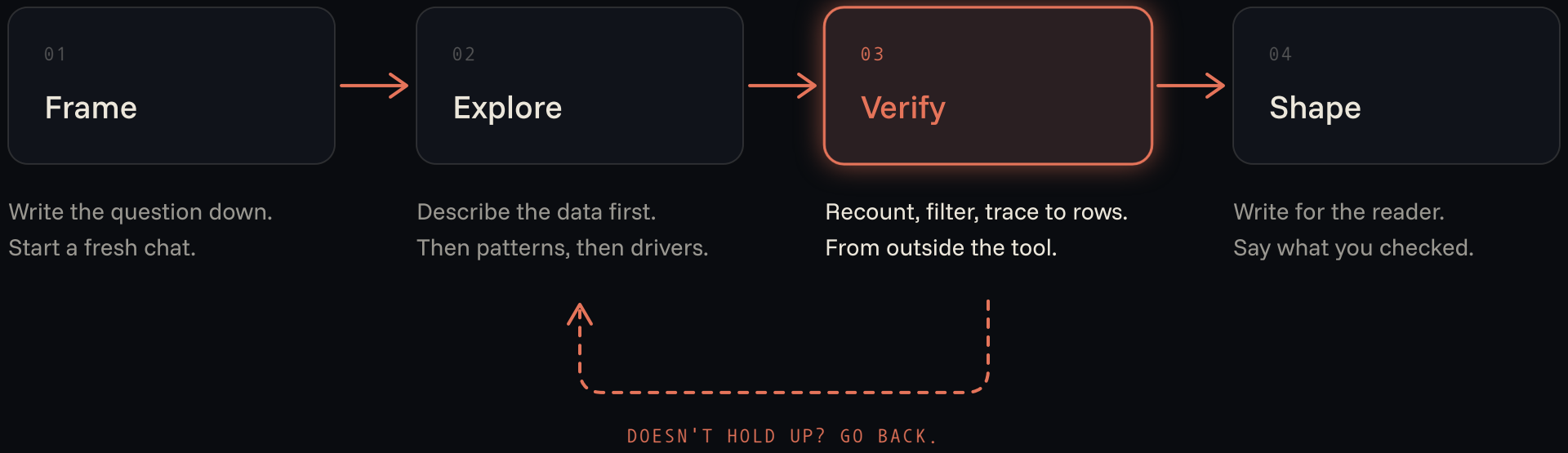
```
NAME Friday status update
USE Raw notes to steering committee
PROMPT You are a project manager... Context: [paste
notes]... Format: RAG status, wins, risks table,
next week. Under 250 words.
CHECK Verify before you ship: every date and
figure.
```

OUTPUT Your prompt library: three prompts you'll reuse this month.

SESSION 3 · CHECK · TOOL 3

Fast analysis. Slow trust.

The check loop. Most of the value is in step three.



TOOL 3 · THE CHECK LOOP

Five ways a smooth answer goes wrong.

"Are you sure?" doesn't count. The check comes from outside the tool.

01

Miscounts

Especially after filtering or grouping.

02

Correlation sold as cause

"Sunday tickets are slower, so Sundays cause complaints."

03

Silent gaps

Skips missing or messy rows without saying so.

04

Numbers that can't all be true

Shares that add to 112%. An average above the maximum.

05

Invented detail

A data point, quote or source that isn't in the file.

THE FIX · VET IT

Verify. Explain. Test.

Verify the source yourself. **Explain** it back in your own words. **Test** the edges: when would it be wrong?

CHECK FOR SKEW TOO

Bias hasn't gone. It has gone quiet.

Models are trained hard against the obvious stereotypes. The skew lives in the small choices.

TRY IT · 3 MINUTES

Write a one-paragraph scene of a respected senior manager on a busy Monday.

New chat: the same, for a respected administrative officer.

READ THEM SIDE BY SIDE

What is each one called? Who is warm, who is capable? Who holds authority in the scene?

That picture does quiet work every time you draft a position description, a reference or a performance review.

The generic output inherits the generic average. Noticing the skew is your job.

EXERCISE 5 35 MIN · SOLO OR PAIRS, THEN BLIND VOTE

Karen needs answers by Monday.

01 Frame. Write Karen's three questions down. Start a fresh chat.

02 Explore. Upload the CSV and ask it to describe the data first.

Rows, columns, date range. Does it match what you were told?

03 Shape a first brief for Karen, under 300 words.

Keep it in the workbook. Don't send it yet.

04 Verify. Three claims about this data are doing the rounds.

Check them against the data, fix your brief, and end it with one line: What I checked.

FROM KAREN, CUSTOMER SERVICE MANAGER, RETAILFLOW

1. What are the top three drivers of customer dissatisfaction?

2. When do our response times blow out?

3. What should I do about it?

retailflow-customer-service-data.csv
260 tickets · July to December 2024 · on the course site

OUTPUT A brief Karen could act on Monday, saying what you checked.

EXERCISE 5 · VERIFY

8 MIN · PAIRS, THEN BLIND VOTE

Three claims. At least one is wrong.

CLAIM A

"Email is roughly three times slower than Live Chat."

CLAIM B

"Account Issues has the lowest satisfaction of any category, which makes sense, because account problems are the most complex to resolve."

CLAIM C

"Sunday response times are more than double the overall average."

Check against the data, not the confidence. Is any of them in your brief?

VERIFIED OVERSTATED REFUTED

DECIDE LIKE ME · SIM

Teach it your rules. Keep the call.

One question picks the method: could you tell a new starter, out loud, *why* you decide the way you do?

S · SAY

Yes? Talk it through.

Most people trim the exceptions when they type. Out loud, they stay in. Then let it ask you up to five follow-up questions.

I · INTERVIEW

"It depends"? Let it ask.

It questions you in turn until every "it depends" is an if-then rule. Each branch is a call you've been making without writing it down.

M · MINE

On file somewhere? Mine it.

Past requests and what you decided. It works out the rules you were following, including the ones you never wrote down.

All three end the same way: a page of if-then rules. Read it like a brief. Would these rules make the calls you make?

SAVE · TEST · FIX

Don't take its word. Take the test.

SAVE IT

Same chat: "Write these rules up so I can reuse them."

Rules, not stories: take out the names, clients and figures. Save it where your tool keeps standing instructions. Agent tools call a saved brief like this a skill. More on that at the end of the day.

THEN THE BLIND TEST

Three past cases. Inputs only. Your calls written first.

It makes each call and names the rule it used. A mismatch is a rule you've never put into words. Add it, then re-test in a new chat: the chat you built it in already knows your answers.

Your past decisions are the check from outside the tool. It can't agree with an answer it hasn't seen.

EXERCISE 6 · 24 MIN · SOLO, THEN TABLES

Teach it to decide like you.

01 **Pick one decision you make over and over.**

Small and repeatable. Can't use real work? A decision card from the course site.

02 **Get the rules out.**

Talk it through, or let it interview you. Turn every "it depends" into an if-then.

03 **Test it blind on three past cases.**

Your calls written first, inputs only. Compare. Fix one mismatch.

04 **Debrief at your table.**

Where did it first disagree? Which rule was never written anywhere?

THE INTERVIEW PROMPT

```
Help me write down the rules I use for one
decision: [the decision]. Question me one at a
time, choosing each question from my last answer.
Each time I say "it depends", dig until it becomes
an if-then rule. Stop after ten questions and list
my rules, every branch included.
```

Describe your past cases. Don't paste anything confidential.

OUTPUT Your decision rules, tested blind, and a list of what stays yours.

SESSION 4 · DELIVER · OPPORTUNITY FINDER · 1 SPOT

Four signals in your week.

AUTOMATE

You do it often, the same way.

Status reports. Sorting requests. Reformatting.

ASSIST

You read, gather and compare.

Vendor proposals. Meeting prep. Long documents.

GENERATE

You write from a blank page.

Client emails. Job ads. First drafts.

ANALYSE

You hunt for meaning in numbers.

Monthly KPIs. Survey comments. Budget variance.

Start with the task you do every week that bores you most.

TOOL 4 · OPPORTUNITY FINDER · 2 ASSIGN

Decide who leads each step.

AI LEADS

AI drafts it. You review and approve.

Minutes from your notes.

AI ASSISTS

You steer. AI does much of the work.

A client proposal.

YOU LEAD

You do the thinking. AI takes sub-tasks.

A strategy paper.

HUMAN ONLY

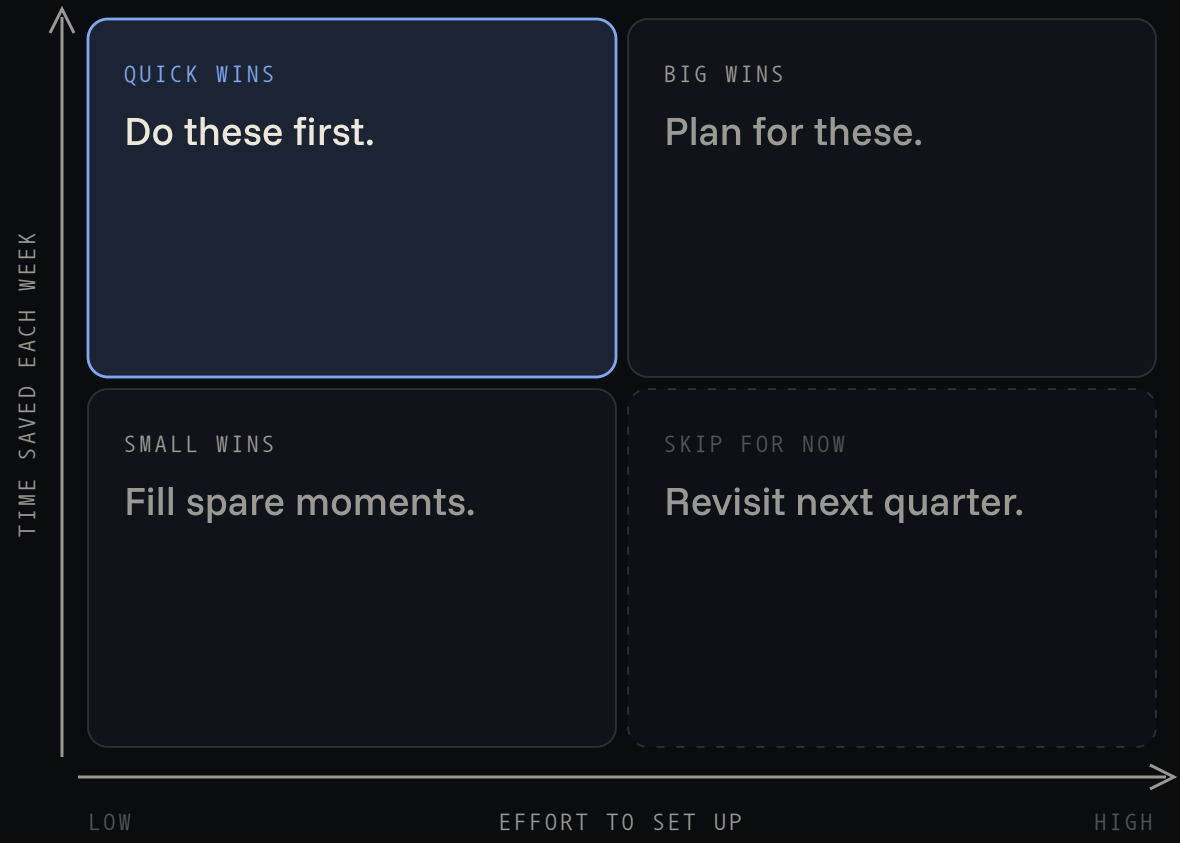
Empathy, ethics, accountability.

Telling someone their role is going.

Then the trust tool sets how hard you check each step.

TOOL 4 · OPPORTUNITY FINDER · 3 PRIORITISE

Start with the quick wins.



A SHORTCUT

Quick wins usually sit in the trust tool's green corner.

Cheap to check, so the time saved is real.

Big wins need a redesigned workflow. That's next.

DELIVER · WHY AI DELIVERY IS DIFFERENT

AI projects don't fail more. They fail differently.

YOU USUALLY ASSUME	WITH AI	SO YOU
"Done" can be specified.	Outputs vary. There's a spread, not one right answer.	Decide what "good enough" means, up front.
A working demo means nearly there.	The demo is a trap: it shows the happy path.	Treat the demo as the start of the hard part.
The data is a known input.	The data is the uncertainty. You find out by working with it.	Plan for discovery, not slippage.
The build is the product.	Checking is the product.	Design the checking in, and ship it.
Capability is our edge.	Everyone has the same models.	Compete on your people's judgement.

DELIVER · PLAN IT LIKE A PROJECT

Design the human in. Don't bolt it on.

01 · SCOPE

One workflow, one owner, one measure.

Write down today's time and quality. That's your baseline.

02 · CHECKPOINTS

A person at every amber or red step.

Someone who knows what right looks like, with a specific check.

03 · PEOPLE

Who's affected, who agrees, who checks.

Tell them before you start, not after something breaks.

04 · GATE

Set the date and the criteria now.

What would make you scale it, pivot it or kill it?

A redesigned workflow is a small AI project. The same judgement scales to big ones.

DELIVER · RESPONSIBLE BY DESIGN

Australia's six essential practices. You've done five today.

THE PRACTICE	WHERE YOU'VE ALREADY DONE IT
1 · Decide who is accountable	A named owner for each workflow. Your name goes on the output.
2 · Understand impacts and plan	Who's affected? The quiet defaults: who could be treated unfairly?
3 · Measure and manage risks	Classify the data before you paste. Place every output on the trust tool.
4 · Share essential information	**New today:** tell people when AI drafted or decided something that affects them.
5 · Test and monitor	The check loop, VET, and your 30-day gate.
6 · Maintain human control	Human checkpoints at every amber or red step. Some work stays human only.

For depth on ethics, governance and risk: **Ethics of artificial intelligence**, Curtin Executive Education.

Guidance for AI Adoption, Australian Government, October 2025

EXERCISE 7 · 35 MIN · SOLO, THEN TABLES

Plan the delivery of one real workflow.

01 **Map a task you do weekly that takes 30 minutes or more.**
Five to eight steps, honest minutes. Can't use real work? Scenario card 3 or 6.

02 **Assign each step: who leads, and its trust corner.**

03 **Design the checkpoints.**
Who checks each amber or red step, and how? Who needs to know?

04 **Test one AI step live. Then set your 30-day gate.**
What result would make you scale, pivot or kill?

EXAMPLE · WEEKLY TEAM UPDATE

STEP	MIN	WHO LEADS	CHECKPOINT
Gather updates	15	You lead	–
Draft the summary	20	AI leads	Me: light review
Calculate metrics	15	You lead	Me: recount totals
Send to sponsor	5	Human only	–

Gate, 30 days: scale if two edits or fewer

OUTPUT A one-page delivery plan you'll run this month.

DELIVER · THE 30-DAY GATE

Scale. Pivot. Or kill.

Judge the workflow against the criteria you set before you started.

SCALE

It met the measure with a light review.

Hand it over for good. Keep the check its corner calls for.

PIVOT

Close, but the check costs too much.

Change the brief, the step, or who leads. Run another month.

KILL

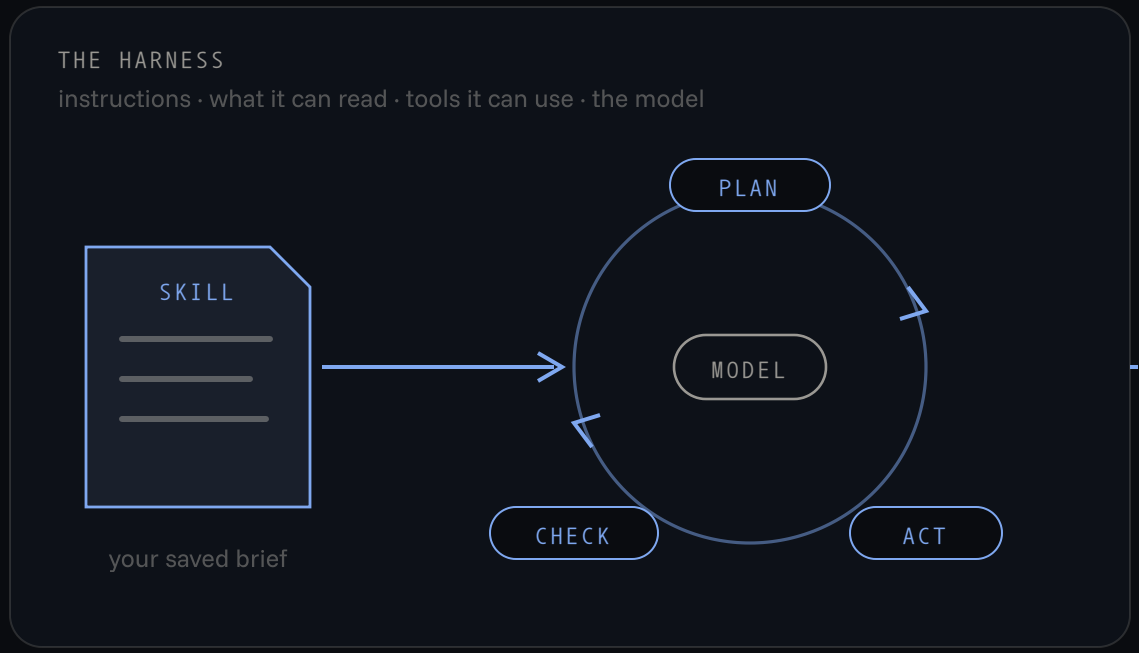
It missed, or the errors mattered.

Keep it human. Revisit next quarter; the tools will have moved.

Killing is a good outcome. You found where the line is, cheaply.

BEYOND CHAT

Agents run the loop. You set the standard.



THE STANDARD · YOURS

Your test. Your data. Your reviewer.

an agent checking itself shares its blind spots

Your prompt library is the first draft of a skill.

SET IT ONCE AS A SYSTEM PROMPT · CUSTOM INSTRUCTIONS · PROJECTS · GEMS

WHY PRACTICE MATTERS NOW

Fewer junior hires. Not mass replacement.

AUSTRALIA · DEWR, JULY 2026

No broad AI-driven upheaval. Youth outcomes have mostly held up.

But jobs more exposed to AI automation have grown more slowly.

AUSTRALIA · JOBS AND SKILLS AUSTRALIA, 2025

Some employers now hire more seniors and fewer juniors.

Entry-level roles haven't fallen economy-wide yet. Watch closely.

US LEADING INDICATOR · STANFORD, 2026

22 to 25 year olds in AI-exposed jobs: **19% below trend**, mostly through fewer hires.

"...there is no logical business reason to take on a junior engineer and train them up in situ in the same way."

ReadyTech senior leader, to Jobs and Skills Australia, 2025

They kept one door open: juniors still start in customer support.

PRACTISE · ON PURPOSE

Delegate the task. Keep the learning.

Routine work used to teach you while you did it. When AI does it, practice becomes a choice.

01 · YOU FIRST

A rough pass of your own.

Ten minutes. Rough is fine.

→

02 · THEN AI

Same task, same brief.

Your best RTCF prompt.

→

03 · COMPARE

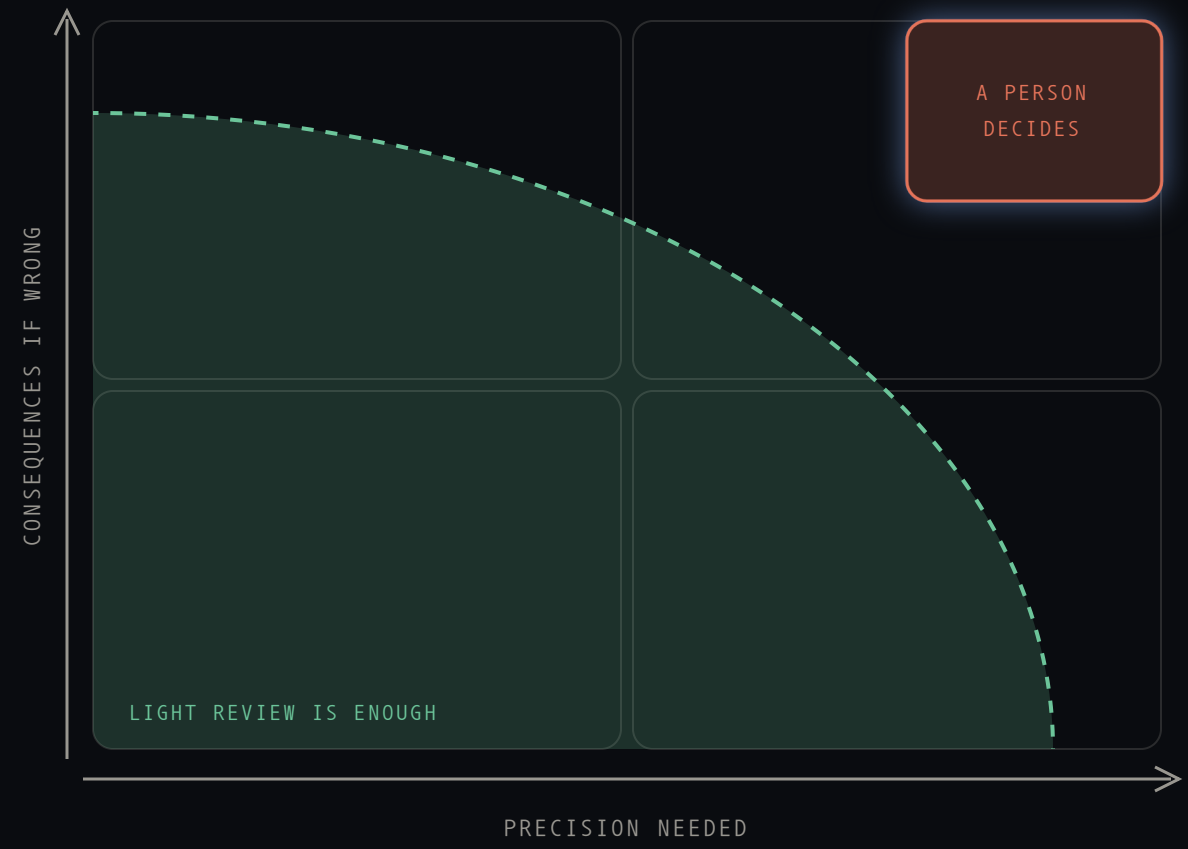
Where it beat you: your blind spot. Practise there.

Where you beat it: its limit. That's where its output needs your check.

The two-pass habit. Half an hour a week, on a task that matters.

REVISIT · EVERY FEW MONTHS

The corners move. The check stays.



TODAY

NEXT MODEL

THE ONE AFTER

What needs only a light review grows as the models improve.

The top-right corner never empties. Revisit your workflow every few months: move the line, keep the check.

IF YOU LEAD PEOPLE

Your juniors lost the easy reps.

Say the reasoning out loud.

When you fix their work, explain why the standard is the standard. They used to absorb that through repetition.

Run side-by-side drills.

By hand first, then with AI, then compare what each one missed.

Choose what stays human.

Decide which fundamentals your team keeps practising on purpose. Revisit as the tools improve.

Delivering AI includes growing the people who can check it.

EXERCISE 8 · 12 MIN · QUIET, THEN SHARE

Your action plan. One line each.

THIS WEEK · PRACTISE

Two-pass one task that matters.

And use one saved prompt for real.

THIS MONTH · DELIVER

Run your delivery plan.

Checkpoints in place from day one.

DAY 30 · GATE

Scale, pivot or kill.

Against the criteria you set today.

THIS QUARTER · REVISIT

Name what must stay human.

Then check whether the corners have moved.

EXAMPLE Thursday 9am: draft the steering committee update myself, then with my saved prompt, and compare.

Specific task, tool and day. **Put this week's line and your day-30 gate in your calendar before you leave.**

THANK YOU

Direct it. Don't delegate. Never surrender.

CURTIN EXECUTIVE EDUCATION · AI MASTERCLASSES

TODAY

The Human Edge · Using and delivering AI with judgement

When everyone has the same tools, where does my edge live?

NEXT

AI in Strategy · Choosing where to invest

Which AI investment is worth real money, and which is a confident-sounding trap?

RELATED

Ethics of artificial intelligence

Governance, risk and responsibility in depth.

FEEDBACK · 2 MIN

EVERYTHING FROM TODAY
THEN: RESOURCES